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How Technology Can Help Your Organisation

Case Study

Broad-basing Management

A management institute, a telecom major and a high-speed connection is enough to learn management—no matter where you are in India

Mithun Kidambi

Nilesh Nayar recently joined a leading software company in Mumbai as an associate consultant. Fresh out of an engineering college with a degree in computer engineering, Nilesh feels a degree in management will help him scale the corporate ladder faster. So why didn't he go in for a post-graduate course in management right after his graduation?

His answer: "Getting a good job right after college is getting pretty tough these days; also, wouldn't work experience help if you want to pursue a management degree later?"

This line of reasoning can be heard from an increasing number of young professionals across the country. India has always had students enrol for management courses right after graduation. This is quite contrary to the trend observed in the West. With work experience being a prime criterion for admission, the average age for students in the first year of management schools, including the likes of Harvard Business School and INSEAD, is around 27 years. We,

however, learn to live life on the fast track right from our kindergarten days. It is therefore natural that most freshers at B-schools around the country are fresh graduates.

But there is also a bunch of people who would like to keep their jobs and get additional qualifications, all in a bid to keep up in the corporate rat-race. The part-time courses (after-hours lessons) offered by almost all management institutes across the country cater to this demand.

Lectures and presentations after work hours do get tiring, but then, there is the next big promotion dangling in front of your eyes! These courses have a few shortcomings, though. The timings may not be suitable to all, and working executives at times have to travel—in the process missing a few lectures. These courses are also restricted to working executives from a particular location. So what could be done to bring in a larger pool of students and make the courses available to many more students, transcending geographical boundaries? This is the 21st century, and there is a very simple credo here: when faced with a problem, think Technology.

Illustration Pradip Ingale

